

CASESTUDY

CYBERBULLYING :

Cyberbullying is a form of online harassment where individuals use digital platforms like social media, messaging apps, or forums to intimidate, threaten, or humiliate others. Unlike traditional bullying, cyberbullying can occur 24/7 and reach a wide audience quickly, often leaving lasting emotional scars.

Typically, cyberbullying begins when a perpetrator sends harmful messages, posts embarrassing photos, or spreads rumors about the victim online. This can happen through direct messages, public comments, or group chats. Sometimes, bullies create fake profiles to target victims anonymously. The behavior may escalate over time, involving more people and causing greater harm.

The primary targets are usually children, teenagers, and young adults, though anyone active online can become a victim. Those who are socially vulnerable, shy, or different in some way (appearance, beliefs, or abilities) are more at risk.

The consequences of cyberbullying are serious and can include anxiety, depression, low self-esteem, and even suicidal thoughts. Victims may withdraw from social activities, perform poorly in school or work, and experience long-term psychological effects. Cyberbullying also affects families and communities, creating a toxic environment.

A notable example is the tragic case of Amanda Todd, a teenager who faced relentless online harassment that led to severe emotional distress and her eventual suicide. This case raised global awareness about the

importance of addressing cyberbullying through education, support systems, and legal measures.

Preventing cyberbullying requires vigilance, promoting empathy, reporting abusive behavior, and teaching digital citizenship.